



Birds catch worms to feed their chicks.

A WORM'S WORK

Earthworms do lots of hidden jobs, especially in the spring and the autumn. This is when most soils are warm and moist. The three main earthworm types are surface worms, topsoil worms, and deep burrowers.



Wildlife Food

Earthworms are an important food for wildlife such as birds and foxes. Foxes catch up to 10 juicy worms a minute.

Different types of earthworm live at different depths.

Leaf decomposers

Red surface worms usually grow to the size of a matchstick. These worms feed on dead leaves near the soil surface. They poo the nutrients from the leaves into the soil.



Surface worms live on top of the soil.

Off-duty worms

Soil can become too dry for earthworms. Then, the worms make small chambers, and curl up into tight knots to rest and avoid losing moisture. This can be for days or months, until the soil conditions improve.



Mucus-lined chambers help worms survive the summer.